

Evidence Before Adjectives

An executive résumé should make a reviewer's next question easier—not merely sound impressive.

THE DECISION

Before adding another adjective, ask what evidence would allow a skeptical reader to believe the claim. Scope, decision, action and result usually travel further than a list of traits.

THREE MOVES

→ Replace one broad claim such as “strategic leader” with a concrete operating decision you owned.

→ Name the scale only when you can explain it: team, budget, customer base, region or delivery risk.

→ Keep the evidence consistent with the stories you can tell in an interview.

TRY THIS BEFORE YOUR NEXT STEP

Choose one résumé bullet today. Underline the action you personally took, then add the context that makes the action meaningful.

Reading note: This is a sample briefing for educational reading. It is not a historic newsletter send and does not guarantee an interview, offer or outcome. Framework reference: [MIT Career Advising & Professional Development — STAR method](#).